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Chapter 4

Using Work Management With Explorer



Why Read This?



Tip: Read this to understand how Work Management affects what you do and see in Explorer. Discusses Action Lists and Action Tracker.



Note: This is an overview and, for detailed instructions, you will be referred to other help guides, such as Explorer online help.

Setting Up Explorer For Work Management



Note: Please refer to the Explorer Online Help for detailed information about System Configuration.

Use the System Configuration Utility to enable the following Explorer options:

- Settings\Work Management\Enable Action List Toolbar Option: enables the user to view or execute pending work management activities.
- Setting\Work Management\Enable Action Tracker Toolbar Option: enables the user to track the progress of document types through the system.
- Menu Auth.\Options Menu\Refresh Action List: enables the user to enable an automatic refresh of the action list.
- Menu Auth.\Action List Context Menu\Overrides: enables the user to reassign or reschedule the selected action list activity.
- Menu Auth.\Options Menu\Role Codes: enables the user to view or edit the role codes associated with role menus. Roles codes are used as the role identifier in the work management database.
- Settings\Work Management\Prompt For Role Code On Menu Creation: With this option enabled the user will be prompted to enter a role code every time a new role menu is created. Roles codes are used as the role identifier in the work management database.
- Menu Auth.\Main\New: enables the user to edit or create role menus.
- Menu Auth.\Main\Save: enables the user to edit or create role menus.
- Menu Auth.\Main\Save As: enables the user to edit or create role menus.
- Menu Auth.\Create Context Menu\: enables the user to edit or create role menus.
- Menu Auth.\Activity Context Menu\: enables the user to edit or create role menus.



Note: For Email configuration details see the Email Server Agent section.

Posting Work To Desktop Using Action Lists



Note: Please refer to the Explorer Online Help for detailed information about Action Lists.



*Note: Recovering From Disaster?
See Action List Overrides menu option.*

Activities that are scheduled in a business process as User Controlled are posted, depending on the recipient defined in the schedule information, to a role or users action list by the work management engine.

These action list activities are stored in the WFP55 file. They are initially posted with a pending status (STAT55='1').

When the action list option is invoked in Explorer, from the toolbar button or tools/action list menu option, a list of the activities waiting to be run for the current user and role are retrieved from the default server, the default server is the first server the user logged onto, if the user has not yet logged on then they will be prompted to do so.

The list is built by retrieving all records from the WFP55 file for the current user and role where the effectivity date and time (TDET55) is less than or equal to the current server date and time.

Role can be changed by selecting a different role menu from the role menu selection box on the main Explorer Window.

User can be changed by using the Change User toolbar button, a user can be selected from the resulting Window.

The action list can be refreshed using the View\Refresh Action List menu option. An automatic refresh can be scheduled via the Tools\Preferences Window.

The Action List Context-sensitive Menu contains the following options:

Run

This executes the activity and is equivalent to double clicking on the activity. Before the activity is executed the current status of the activity is checked to see if it is already active. If active then a message is displayed to the user else the activity is started and the status of the activity changed from pending to active.

The status of the activity is checked by testing the value of the status field (STAT55) from the appropriate record in file WFP55, a value of '1' indicates pending and a value of '2' indicates the activity is active.

Overrides

This option displays the Activity Overrides Window. This Window allows the recipient, priority and schedule settings of the activity to be changed.

Changes will result in the appropriate WFP55 record being updated and in the case of a change in priority or recipient then the progress indicator field (PRIN52) on the matching record in the transaction file WFP52 will be updated to '5' and a new WFP52 record written, based on the old record, containing the new settings.

Removing Entries

If you want to remove all the entries on an Action List or clear down Action Tracker please refer to the following help topics, within the System Preparation And Administration chapter:

- EWM Transaction Purge And Unlock Utility

- Ending EWM Interactively From Application Manager.



Warning: You have to follow both sets of instructions.

Escalation And Delegation

This is controlled by Constructor and is an option on the Work Management Menu: however, the results of the Escalation And Delegation are seen in the Action List of the Explorer user.

Escalation And Delegation is the process whereby Activities which are prompted for a user, by being sent to their Action List, and are not actioned within a configured period, are escalated in priority or escalated to a different user, or both.

Escalation means increasing the priority of an item on an Action List or moving an item from one user's Action List to another user's Action List after a period of time. You could use this, for example, if a manager wanted to pick up all activities outstanding after time. Instead of moving the item to another list, you could give it a higher priority after a period of time, so that it moved higher up the same Action List.

Delegation means moving an item automatically from one user's Action List to another user's Action List. You could use this where someone was on holiday or absent for a period of time, so that the items would appear only in the Action List of the user who was taking over that activity.

When defining processes, an activity that is to appear on an Action List is assigned a priority of High, Medium or Low and they appear on the Action Lists in that order. Escalation Rules can be set to increase the priority of an item over time and this enables the priority to be raised to a status of Urgent, which is higher than High. Action List items which are urgent have a symbol with an exclamation mark.

Urgent:



Keeping Track Of Documents Using Action Tracker



Note: Please refer to the Explorer Online Help for detailed information about Action Tracker.



Note: Recovering From Disaster? See Action Tracker Cancel menu option.

The Action Tracker function allows the user to track the progress of document types through the system.

All transactions performed under work management control are stored in the work management audit file WFP52, Action Tracker performs various reports over this file.

When the Action Tracker option is invoked in Explorer, from the toolbar button or Tools/Action Tracker menu option, the Action Tracker Window is displayed. This Window allows the user to search for documents based on document type, document reference, role and document status.

Action Tracker displays the business objects with Icons alongside. There are many different icons which all represent a different status and type of action. The colour of the icon represents the status, and the design of the icon represents the action.

Statuses

There are four statuses shown by icon colours. The actual design of the icon will vary according to the action type:

Pending (Status 1) - Red icons: 

Active (Status 2) - Yellow Icons: 

Completed (Status 3) - Green Icons: 

Cancelled (Status 4) - White icons with a red cross: 

Two statuses are shown by icon designs:

Reassigned (Status 5):  This means it has been Escalation or Delegated.

Unknown: 

Actions

There are six type of actions, shown by six different designs of icon. The actual colour of the icon displayed will depend upon the status of the action, as detailed earlier in this section.

Automatic batch: 

Scheduled batch: 

Automatic Immediate: 

User Controlled - Role: 

User Controlled - User: 

User Controlled - Email: 

If an activity in the search results list is selected then the following options are available either from the file menu or the right click context menu:

Cancel

This option is only enabled for activities with a pending status. The option changes the status of the selected activity to completed.

This results in the progress indicator field (PRIN52) on the work management transaction file WFP52 being set to '9' for the selected activity.

Completion Details

This option is only enabled for activities with a completed status. The option displays the completion details Window. This Window displays output details for the selected activity.



Note: The completion details for an activity are held on file WFP53.

Audit

This option creates a new search results list based on the document type and reference associated with the selected activity. This search is equivalent to manually selecting the document type and reference and performing a search. The search list created represents an audit trail of the document through the work management system.

Trace

This option creates a new search result list based on two factors. Firstly, as for the audit, all activities whatever the status for the selected document type and reference will be displayed. Also, any subsequent documents, created under Work Management control by virtue of the selected document will also be displayed. For Example, if the picking routine is run under Work Management control then the output documents from picking will be both the sales order and the pick note. If a trace is performed on the sales order then all activities performed for the pick note will also be displayed.

This option creates a new search results list based on the thread identifier for the document associated with the selected activity. As well as containing documents which have the same thread identifier as the selected document the list will also contain documents with thread identifiers which were created from or created the current thread identifier.

All documents created in a business process are stamped with the same unique thread identifier e.g. the Picking Notes activity has a Sales Order as it's input document type and the same Sales Order plus a Pick Note as it's output document types. If the Sales Order is created at the start of a business process then it will be assigned a unique thread identifier, after the Sales Order passes through the Picking Notes activity it will still have the same thread identifier, that thread identifier will also be assigned to the newly created Pick Note document providing the activity is run under work management control. If the Sales Order is used in another business i.e. Order Amend then it will still retain the same thread identifier it was originally assigned.

In some cases a new thread identifier is assigned to output document types e.g. the Confirmation of Dispatch activity accepts multiple documents of type Pick Note as it's input and

outputs a consolidated Invoice. In this case a new thread identifier is assigned to the output Invoice document as it was generated from many input documents each of which has it's own thread identifier, the relationship between the new thread identifier and it's parent thread identifiers is stored and so Action Tracker is able to include all documents in it's trace list.



Note: The relationships between thread identifiers are stored in the thread cross references file WFP56.

Execute

This option is only enabled for entries that have a pending status and are to be user invoked. The option is equivalent to the Run option on the action list context menu .

Removing Entries

If you want to remove all the entries on an Action List or clear down Action Tracker please refer to the following help topics, within the System Preparation And Administration chapter:

- EWM Transaction Purge And Unlock Utility
- Ending EWM Interactively From Application Manager.



Warning: You have to follow both sets of instructions.

Creating New Roles And Users



Note: Please refer to the Explorer Online Help where there is a Tutorial which explains how to add new Roles and Users. Look for the section called User Role Maintenance.

Roles

Creating a new role merely requires a new role menu to be created in Explorer, once created this role will be available within constructor when defining business processes and activity details assuming the role menu file exists in the role menu directory used by constructor and that the role menu has a role code associated with it. Roles codes are used as the role identifier in the work management database. The Options\Role Codes menu option can be used to add or edit these codes. If the Prompt For Role Code On Menu Creation setting is enabled, see How to setup Explorer for Work Management, then when a new role menu is created the user will be prompted to enter a role code.

A role menu can be created by using the File menu options New or Save As. Activities can be added to a role menu by either dragging them from the role menu designer activity list and dropping them onto the role menu workspace or by taking the New\Activity\Elemental menu option from the role menu context menu. When adding an activity via the context menu the Properties For a New Activity Window will be displayed, the user is prompted to enter the activity title and the activity task code. The role menu context menu is invoked by right clicking on an empty space in the role menu workspace. The properties of existing activities can be edited by right clicking on the activity and taking the Properties option from the resultant context menu.

Creating New Users

Users can be created using the User Role Maintenance Utility. To install this utility you must take the Administration Tools option when installing Explorer. The utility allows the user to create new users, edit existing users and authorise users to specific roles.

The user/role information is stored in the Roles table in the JBARTime.mdb access database.

Business Processes

The only time an Explorer user is aware of the Business Process, under which control the activities are running, is when they execute an activity which is the initial activity for more than one Business Process. The Work Management Engine displays a list of all these Business Processes, showing the name and version, and the Explorer user selects the appropriate process.

Please Refer to Initial Activity in System Preparation And administration.